

Being a jack of all trades when you aim to be a game designer is all the more important because you will be working with a host of specialised departments within your organisation. So, having even the most basic understanding of several moving parts of the game design process will make sure that you can give meaningful feedback to the rest of the team involved in the game development process.

Where do I level up?

If you have read so far, you would already have an understanding of what skills you need. And I will only add meaningless words by talking about them. But, just to make sure that you and I are on the same page, here are some skills that you need to master –

- Storytelling and character development
- Critical thinking and trend identification
- Teamwork and personnel management
- Project management and interdepartmental coordination
- Game development and design, including programming

What's the playing field like?

India as a market in the global gaming scheme of things, has shown a lot of

"I started out as a game programmer purely by chance. In that same firm, thanks to my collegemate and colleague, I got the opportunity to try my hands at game design. I recall falling in love with the Dungeons & Dragons manuals that were given to me for reference for a game I had to design. I barely knew what game design was then, and yet jumped into it, head first, and am loving it still! I've tried a range of things – production, product management, heading a studio, being an entrepreneur. It has been an interesting ride full of ups and downs.

I believe games can do so much more, it is such a wonderful and dynamic medium. It's this strong belief that keeps me going."

POORNIMA SEETHARAMAN

India's first video game designer to join the Global Gaming Hall of Fame, in an interview with Life-style Asia when asked about her start as a game designer

promise. Major game development and design studios have entered the market with tons of money, hope, and, most importantly, job opportunities. Not only that, some of the major game studios and related organisations have also collaborated with local insti-

tutions to provide expert guidance to students. What this means is that if you are in the right place, you can get a massive head start.

Talking about numbers, a simple Google search reveals the immense potential game design holds. Job portals like Naukri, LinkedIn, and others have over ten thousand job listings in total, related to the keyword of "game designer". If you have looked for jobs, even out of curiosity, you will know that across organisations, job descriptions vary a lot, even when the job title is the same. So, when you are searching for a job, make sure to go through the description that they offer as well.

In terms of the money that you can make, according to Glassdoor, the average base salary of a game designer in India is around ₹8,00,000 per annum. And, as for the game studios that are active in the country, right now, the list is vast, and we are sure that you will be surprised to see some of the names –

- Electronic Arts
- Rockstar Games
- Reliance Games
- Tata Consultancy Services
- Zynga Games
- Ubisoft
- 99Games

Imagine your name coming in the credits of GTA VI or the next title in the Rainbow Six game franchise? Don't build castles in thin air just yet. There's a lot of work that you will need to put in to make sure that you are worthy of being hired by gaming studios who bring us some of the best titles.

Now what?

I don't know. I am sitting here reading about game design and writing this article for you. If you have read through this article, you know what to do next. Why are you still here? Go, go, go! Get started! And I am sure you will make it big. When you do, though, remember SKOAR! does video game reviews and, we'd love to see what one of our minions achieved! *

